

Chain Story

A story written by everyone — and read by no one, until the end.

GROUPS OF 3-6 · ~10 MINUTES · PENCILS ONLY · NO PREP — ONE SHEET PER GROUP

THE STORY STARTS HERE:

Once, at exactly midnight, the school's pet hamster opened one eye and said...

WRITER 1

----- write your line, then fold back along this line and pass left -----
WRITER 2

----- write your line, then fold back along this line and pass left -----
WRITER 3

----- write your line, then fold back along this line and pass left -----
WRITER 4

----- write your line, then fold back along this line and pass left -----
WRITER 5

----- write your line, then fold back along this line and pass left -----
WRITER 6

----- write your line, then fold back along this line and pass left -----

UNFOLD & READ ALOUD — every group reads its story to the class. Expect chaos.

Teacher's Quick Guide

Chain Story — everything useful, nothing else.

WHY IT WORKS

Nobody sees the whole story until the end, so there is no wrong line and no way to fall behind. Reluctant writers only ever owe one sentence.

HOW TO RUN IT

Hand one sheet to each group. Point at the sheet. That's the whole setup — the rules are printed at every fold.

DRAWING MODE

Groups that write slowly can draw their line instead. Same folds, same chaos.

MIXED AGES

Seat stronger writers at zones 1 and 6 (the opening and the ending) and let everyone else land anywhere in the middle.

TIMING

About 90 seconds per fold keeps a class of groups roughly in sync. Call the passes out loud if the room drifts.

THE READ-ALoud

It's the whole payoff. Keep it — even if you have to cut the writing short.

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THE CASE STARTS HERE:

The locker at the end of the hall had been sealed for twenty years — until this morning.

WRITER 1

----- write your line, then fold back along this line and pass left -----
WRITER 2

----- write your line, then fold back along this line and pass left -----
WRITER 3

----- write your line, then fold back along this line and pass left -----
WRITER 4

----- write your line, then fold back along this line and pass left -----
WRITER 5

----- write your line, then fold back along this line and pass left -----
WRITER 6

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